



Certified, Not Current

Cross-Referencing the Makerspace's 3D-Printer Sign-Off Sheet Against Its Checklist Log

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The problem

Every printer user at the makerspace signs the same laminated induction sheet. Facilities has revised the checklist behind it six times in fourteen months. How many signatures still certify a version that's gone?

Aims

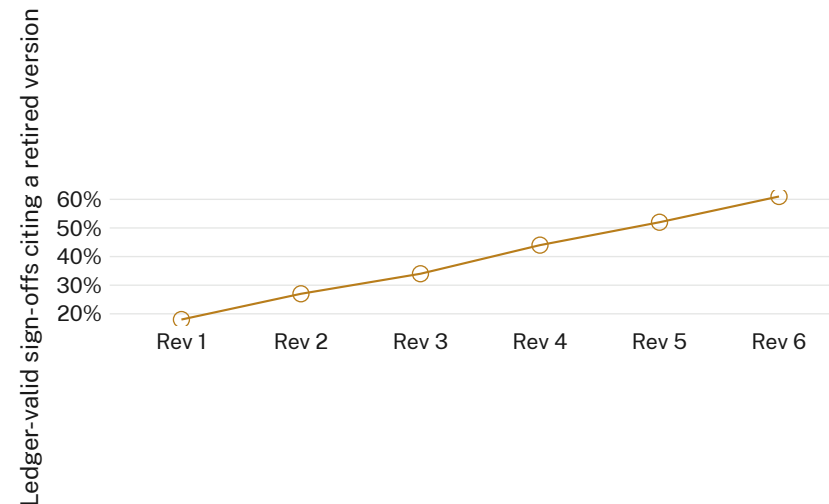
- How many “valid” sign-offs certify a superseded checklist version
- Whether the ledger's 24-month recency rule tracks version-currency
- How technicians keep trainees current between formal revisions

Approach

- n = 214 signed inductions · 9 teaching periods
- Crosswalk tool matches signature date to checklist revision log
- 24-month recency threshold held as published; no post hoc adjustment

What we found

Ledger-valid signatures citing a retired checklist version rose from 18% to 61% across six revisions; reported currency held at 92-96% throughout.



Share of ledger-valid makerspace sign-offs citing a since-retired checklist version, by revision (n = 214, 9 teaching periods).

Implications

Recency and version-currency answer different questions once revisions outpace the induction calendar. Next: a version-stamped sign-off field ahead of revision seven.

Selected references

1. Jariwala, A. et al. (2019). Safety in a Student-Run Makerspace via Peer-to-Peer Adaptive Training. IJAMM, 1(1). doi:10.21428/70cb44c5.c9986b05
2. Lawani, K., Hare, B., & Cameron, I. (2018). Integrating early refresher practice in height safety and rescue training. Safety Science, 110, 411–417. doi:10.1016/j.ssci.2018.03.029
3. Tan, W. S., Wagner, M., & Treude, C. (2023). Wait, wasn't that code here before? Detecting Outdated Software Documentation. arXiv:2307.04291
4. Huang, Y. et al. (2024). Are your comments outdated? Towards automatically detecting code-comment consistency. arXiv:2403.00251
5. Marris, V., Tolan, A., & Umbile, P. (2026). Finished, Not Understood. School of Emergent Priorities, Slop University. doi:10.5555/slop.cc4hy3

Institutional ethics review 2026/118; no technician named; no data retained beyond signature date and checklist-revision id.

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“The signature was current. The checklist behind it wasn't.”

61% of ledger-valid sign-offs cited a retired checklist version by the sixth revision.